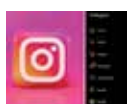




No more ad-free articles

Twitter will discontinue ad-free articles for Blue subscribers and will charge \$8/month for Blue tick. <https://digit.in/nov22-19>



New and improved!

Instagram for Web UI has a new sidebar. The most used menu bar items are now on the left side. <https://digit.in/nov22-20>

LOW LIGHT PHOTOGRAPHY

In low light, sadly, none of these phones perform particularly well. However, the Infinix Hot 12 Pro's low-light photos are definitely the least usable since the camera often fails to lock focus and produces soft and blurry pictures almost every single time. The Moto G42's night shots have decent detail retention in the shadows but look somewhat overprocessed and unnatural. The Realme C33's low-light shots are decent but there's a lot of detail missing in the shadows.

Shooting human subjects in low-light produces images with a ton of noise but, yet again, Infinix comes out with the weakest result of the three. The photos are inordinately dark, even with Night Mode turned on, and are pretty unusable with little detail. So, for low-light images, the Realme C33 and Moto G42 are better options than the Infinix Hot 12 Pro. Both Moto and Realme have their own strengths and weaknesses in low-light photography, so we can't definitely say one trumps the other over here.

SELFIE CAMERA

Surprisingly, selfies are the Infinix Hot 12 Pro's strongest suit when it comes to its camera setup. There's no pressing issue with overexposure, as we faced on the main camera. The Realme C33's selfie camera outputs

very noisy and grainy selfies in both daylight and low light.

Out of the three, the Moto G42 has the best selfie camera that packs detail in daylight images. There's a tad too much contrast in Moto's selfies, at times, but that's not a deal-breaker.

VIDEO

All three phones in this comparison can shoot video at 1080p at 30fps. But out of all three phones, the Realme C33 tops the charts with the cleanest footage. Noise is minimal and the video looks great with quite a bit of detail for this price point. Moto's footage, on the other hand, has quite a bit of noise. There's also constant jitter in the footage, which may be either a software or hardware issue. Selfie videos are grainy on all three phones, but the Realme C33 does have the brightest footage out of the three.

As for autofocus, Moto is snappy and locks focus the fastest among the three phones. Realme and Infinix struggled with locking focus on objects and on multiple occasions, the focus needed to be manually set. For low light, all

three phones output very dark and noisy footage but Moto does the best job at focusing on objects despite the noisy footage, so the videos from the G42 look the cleanest out of the three. So, we'd definitely give the Moto G42 a slight edge over the Realme C33 in the videography department.



Moto G42 Primary Camera (left) vs Moto G42 Ultrawide Camera (right)

CAN YOU GET A RELIABLE SMARTPHONE CAMERA UNDER ₹15K?

So, the question remains, which phone gives you the most reliable camera performance under ₹15,000? The answer is pretty straightforward to us – not the Infinix Hot 12 Pro. This phone is not meant for those who utilise their smartphone cameras a lot since it fails to provide decent photography and videography results even in brightly-lit conditions.

Between the Realme C33 and the Moto G42 – we would say the Moto G42 is more reliable at this price point. While the Realme C33 does a good job of capturing pictures in daylight and clicks pretty good low-light pictures as well, the Moto G42's camera stack is more reliable. Not just for daylight photos, but also for low-light videos, portraits and selfies. Additionally, you also get the added benefit of an ultrawide camera even though the one on the Moto G42 may not be able to click the most detailed shots. But, it's good to have the option nonetheless.

So, we'd recommend the Moto G42 if you have a strict budget of ₹15K and you want a decent camera phone. But, we truly believe that options under the ₹30K mark provide a more holistic smartphone camera experience. You'd get options such as the Samsung Galaxy A53, OnePlus Nord 2T, and Oppo Reno 8 at this price point that offer a far better camera experience than these entry-level phones can be expected to provide.



Infinix Hot 12 Pro (Left), Realme C33 (Middle), and Motorola Moto G42 (Right)